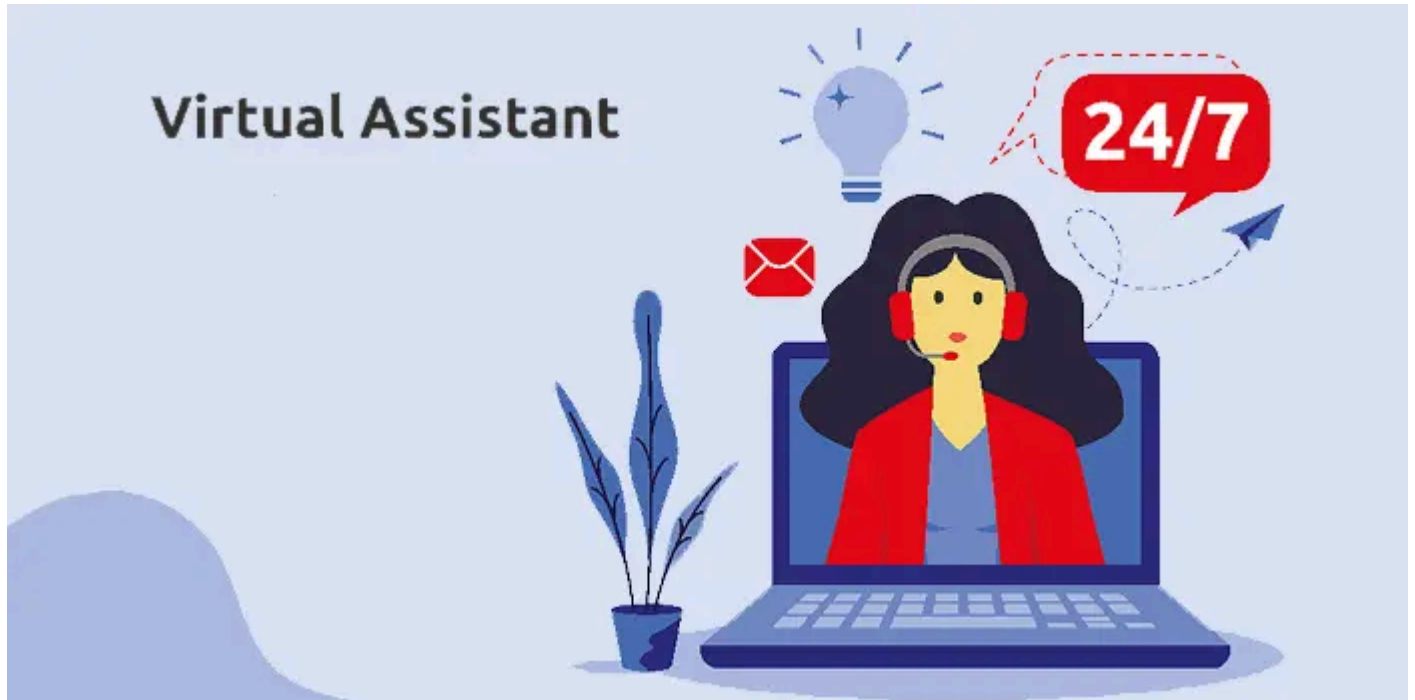


ADMINISTRATIVE & EXECUTIVE VA SKILLS

Complete Class Notes — Concepts + Practicals for Beginners



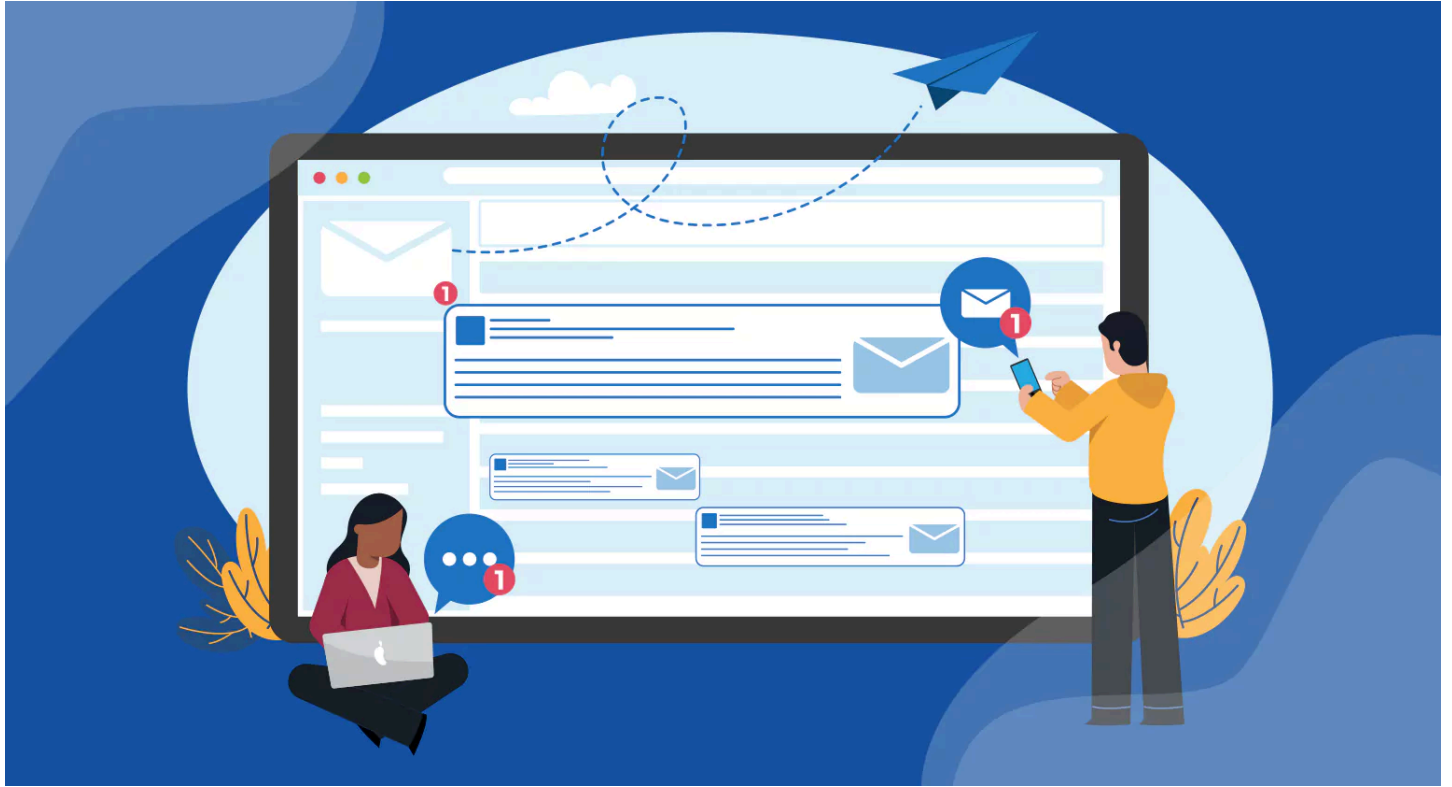
Introduction to Administrative & Executive VA Skills

Administrative and Executive Virtual Assistants help business owners manage daily tasks such as **emails, scheduling, files, data, reports, and communication**.

Your goal is to **make the client's life easier** by staying organized, reliable, and professional.

◆ SECTION 1: EMAIL MANAGEMENT

1.1 What is Email Management?



Email management means:

- Organizing a client's inbox
- Responding to messages professionally
- Removing spam
- Categorizing messages
- Keeping the inbox clean and easy to use

A VA must aim for **Inbox Zero** — not literally empty, but everything is sorted and not chaotic.

1.2 Why Email Management Matters

- Saves your client time
- Prevents missed opportunities
- Helps track conversations
- Keeps business communication professional

1.3 Key Concepts in Email Management

► Labels / Folders

Used to categorize emails

Examples: *Clients*, *Invoices*, *Meetings*, *Urgent*, *Follow Up*

► Filters / Rules

Automatically sort messages based on:

- Sender
- Subject
- Keywords

Example:

A filter that puts all emails containing “Invoice” → into *Invoices* folder

► Archiving

Moves emails out of the inbox but keeps them saved.

NOT deleting.

► Snoozing (Gmail)

Removes an email temporarily and brings it back at a specific time.

1.4 How to Manage a Professional Inbox (Step-by-Step)

STEP 1: Scan inbox and remove spam

STEP 2: Organize important emails into folders

STEP 3: Reply to quick messages (takes < 2 minutes)

STEP 4: Flag or star emails requiring follow-up

STEP 5: Set filters to automate inbox sorting

1.5 Email Management Templates

Template: Responding to a Client's Customer

Hello [Name],

Thank you for reaching out. I have received your message and will look into this immediately.
I will provide an update within [time period].

Kind regards,

[Your Name]

VA to [Client Name]

Template: Professional Follow-Up

Hello [Name],

Just following up on my previous email.

Kindly let me know if you need any clarification.

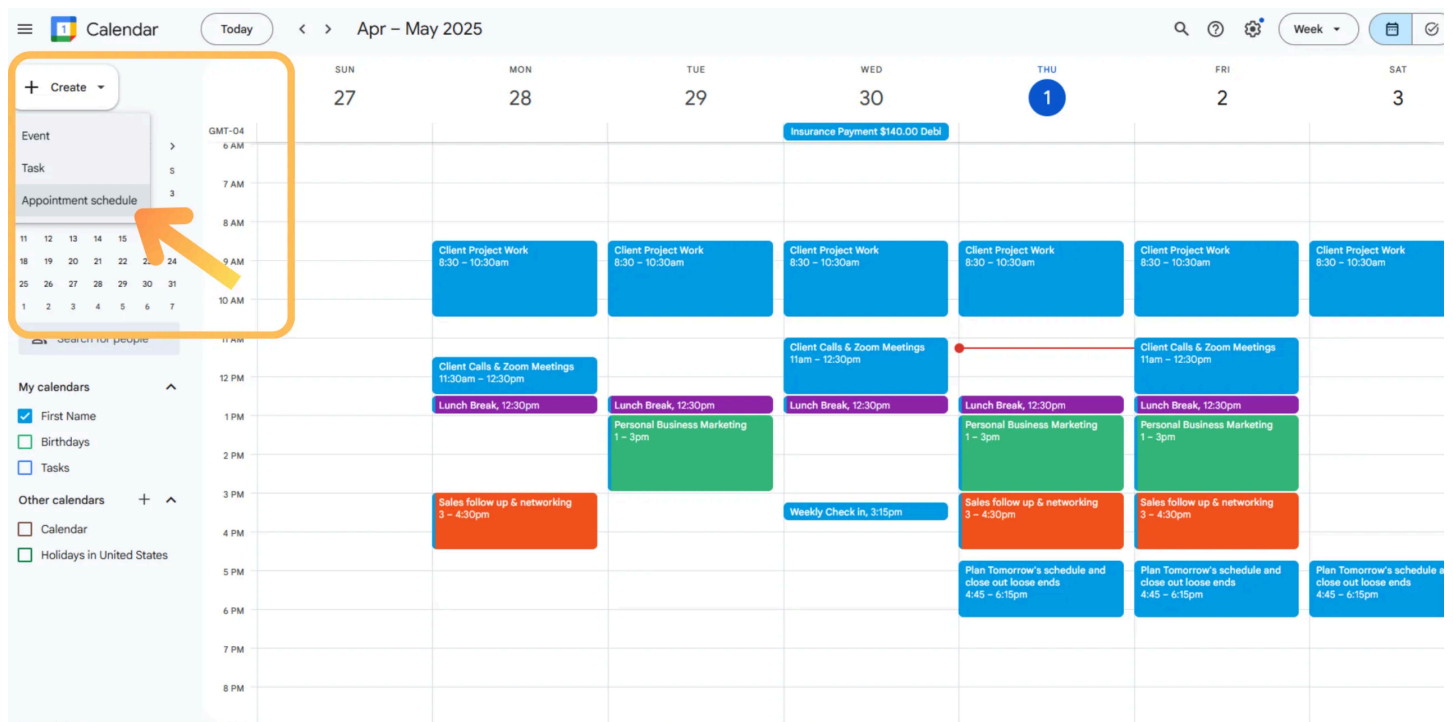
Thank you.

1.6 PRACTICAL EXERCISES

1. Create a Gmail account
2. Create these folders: *Urgent, Pending, Completed, Invoices*
3. Create a filter: “If subject contains Invoice → move to Invoices folder”
4. Practice replying to 5 sample email templates
5. Move 20 emails into appropriate folders

◆ SECTION 2: CALENDAR & APPOINTMENT SCHEDULING

2.1 What is Calendar Management?



Managing a client's time using virtual calendars like:

- Google Calendar
- Outlook Calendar
- Calendly

Your role:

Ensure the client never forgets a meeting, double-books, or misses an event.

2.2 Key Concepts

✓ Time Zones

Always confirm client and meeting participants' time zones.

✓ Color Coding

Use colors to mark different types of events:

- Blue – Meetings
- Green – Personal
- Red – Urgent tasks

✓ Reminders

Set 10-min, 1-hour, and 1-day reminders.

2.3 How to Schedule a Meeting (Beginner Steps)

Using Google Calendar:

1. Open Google Calendar
2. Click "+ Create"
3. Add event title
4. Add meeting description
5. Add Google Meet or Zoom link
6. Add participants' emails
7. Set reminders
8. Save

2.4 Appointment Scheduling Rules

A professional VA must:

- Confirm availability before scheduling
- Avoid back-to-back meetings unless allowed
- Provide buffer time between meetings

2.5 Scheduling Templates

Template: Confirming Meeting Time

Hello [Name],
Please confirm if you are available for a meeting on:
Date: [DD/MM/YYYY]
Time: [Time + Time Zone]

Thank you.

Template: Sending a Meeting Invite

Hello [Name],
Your meeting has been scheduled as follows:
Topic: [Meeting Topic]
Date: [DD/MM/YYYY]
Time: [Time + Time Zone]
Link: [Meeting Link]

Feel free to let me know if you need changes.

2.6 PRACTICAL EXERCISES

1. Create 4 sample calendar events
2. Add reminders on each
3. Add conferencing links (Zoom or Google Meet)
4. Practice editing and rescheduling events
5. Convert a time from EST to WAT and schedule properly

◆ **SECTION 3: DATA ENTRY & DOCUMENTATION**

3.1 What is Data Entry?



Typing information into:

- Google Sheets
- MS Excel
- CRM systems
- Registration forms
- Databases

You must be:

- ✓ Fast
- ✓ Accurate
- ✓ Organized

3.2 Basic Spreadsheet Concepts (Beginner-Friendly)

✓ Rows = Horizontal

✓ Columns = Vertical

✓ Cell = Intersection of row and column (example: B3)

✓ Sheet = One tab in a spreadsheet

3.3 Common Data Entry Tasks for VAs

- Updating contact lists
- Entering sales records
- Filling forms
- Updating CRM entries
- Creating reports

3.4 Documentation (Writing & Formatting)

VAs prepare:

- Meeting notes
- Reports
- SOPs
- Project documentation

Good Documentation Should Be:

- Clear
- Simple
- Well-organized
- Free of grammar errors

3.5 How to Format Documents Professionally

- ✓ Use headings
- ✓ Use bullet points
- ✓ Keep paragraphs short
- ✓ Use consistent fonts
- ✓ Use bold for important text

3.6 PRACTICAL EXERCISES

A. Data Entry Exercise

Create a spreadsheet with:

- Name
- Phone number
- Email
- Status

Enter 30 dummy contacts.

B. Documentation Exercise

Write a 1-page report:

- Topic: "Weekly Summary of Tasks Completed"
- Include: title, bullet points, conclusion

C. Formatting Exercise

Open Google Docs → Format the report using:

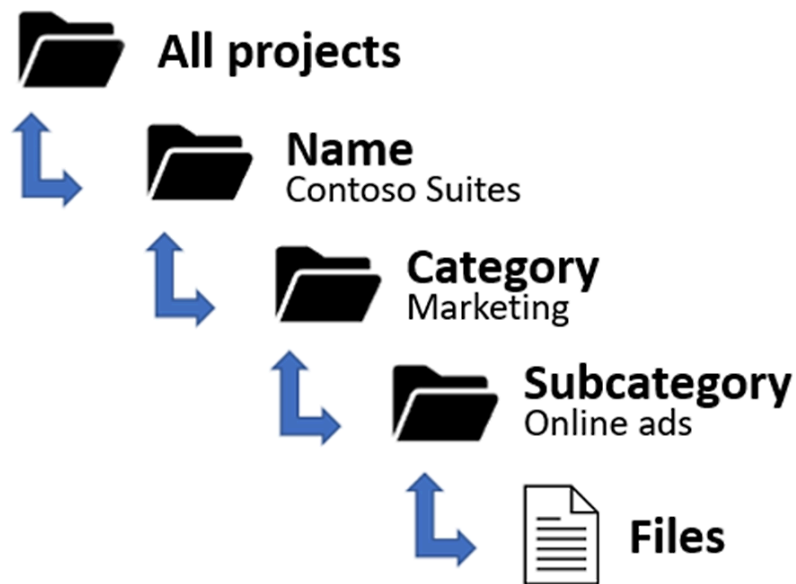
- Heading styles

- Bullet points
- Page numbering

◆ **SECTION 4: FILE & FOLDER ORGANIZATION**

4.1 What This Means

Organizing a client's files in Google Drive, Dropbox, or OneDrive.



4.2 Ideal Folder Structure Example

```

Client Name/
  Admin/
  Finance/
    Invoices/
    Receipts/
  Projects/
    Project A/
    Project B/
  Meetings/
    Notes/
    Recordings/
  
```

4.3 Naming Files Properly

Use Clear, Consistent Naming:

✗ Bad:

“doc1”, “photo.jpg”, “random file.pdf”

✓ Good:

“Invoice_2025_001_Jan.pdf”

“MeetingNotes_28Nov2025.docx”

4.4 PRACTICAL EXERCISE

1. Open Google Drive
2. Create the folder structure above
3. Upload 10 sample files
4. Rename them professionally
5. Share the folder with a dummy email

◆ FINAL PROJECT FOR MODULE 3

Complete the following:

- ✓ **Organize a sample email inbox**
- ✓ **Create and manage 5 calendar events**
- ✓ **Build a 30-record spreadsheet**
- ✓ **Create a formatted 1-page weekly report**
- ✓ **Build a professional folder structure in Google Drive**

The output will form part of the student's **portfolio**.